

Introduction to Animal Breeding and Welfare

Land Sciences

May, 2026

Introduction to Animal Breeding and Welfare (A11421)

Short Title: Animal Breeding and Welfare
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Land Sciences
Cluster Agriculture
Author JRYAN
Credits 5

Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

This module will enable the student to acquire the knowledge and skills to manage a farm in a way that satisfies the welfare requirements of livestock. It will enable the student to acquire the principles, knowledge and skills needed to breed and calf cows and rear calves to 12 weeks of age.

Programmes

AGRI -0101 BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)

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Indicative Content

- Reproductive diseases of dairy cows, suckler cows, cattle and sheep
- Dairy and suckler cow welfare
- Cattle welfare
- Breeding management of dairy and suckler cows and young stock
- Sire selection
- Calving process
- Calving problems
- Management and programme for calf rearing
- Systems of calf rearing

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Describe reproductive diseases of dairy cows, suckler cows, cattle and sheep.
2. Complete safely a range of skills associated with breeding, calving, feeding with both cows and calves due regard to good environmental practice and the animal's health and welfare.
3. Describe the management and operation requirements associated with both cows and calves during the breeding cycle.
4. Describe good practices for animal health and welfare.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Practical instruction.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	1,3,4
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>Practical</i>	30%	2
<i>Assignment</i>	20%	3

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter.

40%-49%: Will be able to show a good knowledge of the key learning outcomes.

50%-59%: As well as the above, the student will be able to demonstrate an understanding of some of the complexities of the topics.

60%-69%: In addition, the student will demonstrate more detailed knowledge of the all topics, and demonstrate an ability to evaluate detailed knowledge acquired in the module to new material.

70%-100%: The learner will be able to demonstrate comprehensive knowledge and understanding of all learning outcomes, and an ability to evaluate and relate topics that overlap all of the learning outcomes.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	24	
Field Trips	24	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- McMonagle , J. *_Animal Health & Welfare_*. Edition. Oakpark: Teagasc, 2002.
- McMonagle , J. *_Introduction to Farm Animals_*. Edition. Oakpark: Teagasc, 2002.
- O' Halloran, J. *_Breeding & Calving Cows_*. Edition. Oakpark: Teagasc, 2002.
- Tully, E. *_Calf Rearing_*. Oakpark: Teagasc, 2002.

Supplementary Material

- Boatfield , G. *_Farm Livestock_*. Edition. UK: Farming Press, 1994.
- Ewbank , R. *_Management & Welfare of Farm Animals_*. Edition. UK: UFAW, 1999.
- Malcolm , B. *_Introduction to Practical Animal Breeding_*. 4th. UK: Blackwell Science, 1998.
- Thickett , B. *_Calf Rearing_*. UK: Farming Press, 2003.